Lynkr.

A free "get-noticed" coach for Indian freshers and early-career job seekers. It helps you get replies from real people on LinkedIn without sounding like AI.

What the app does, in detail | Every feature | Privacy and safety | Technology | Testing and status

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1. Lynkr at a glance

Who it is for	Indian freshers and early-career job seekers: final-year students and people with 0 to 2 years of experience.
The promise	Get replies from real people on LinkedIn without sounding like AI.
Price and login	Free. No account, no login. Nothing to install: it runs in the browser.
What it produces	A Story Vault of your real facts, a profile fix (3 headlines, an About section, specific gaps), outreach messages matched to how well you know the person, a follow-up, 3 posts, 2 comments, a weekly action plan on a calendar, and a Connect Coach for finding and approaching people.
What it never does	Log in to LinkedIn, scrape LinkedIn, post for you, send messages or connection requests for you, or invent facts about you.
Where your data lives	In your own browser (localStorage). Lynkr's server does not store your answers.
Language	Plain Indian English. No Hinglish output, emojis, hashtags or stock LinkedIn phrases.

2. Why Lynkr exists

Lynkr's shape comes from research on 1,059 Reddit posts and 130 threads about LinkedIn and job hunting. Of 516 real voices, 223 were job seekers or freshers. The main pains:

- **Recruiter silence and the "Easy Apply black hole":** applications disappear without a reply.
- **Distrust of polished AI text:** readers spot generic AI writing and ignore it. Ghostwriters who succeeded used interviews and the person's own stories, not templates.
- **Referrals:** people who give referrals want a job ID and a resume. Strangers rarely refer strangers, because a referral spends the referrer's reputation.
- **Fear of bans and scams:** users worry about tools that automate LinkedIn; one student was asked by a "profile expert" for their LinkedIn password.

So Lynkr interviews you for specifics, writes only from your facts, leaves blanks rather than inventing, matches each ask to the relationship, and never touches your LinkedIn account.

3. How a session works, start to finish

1. **Setup:** choose a goal and target role, describe your background in a line or two, and optionally paste your current headline and About.
2. **Interview:** answer one question at a time (typed or spoken), usually 6 to 8. Lynkr digs for specifics: what you built, a number, proof for the role, a setback, what is hard about your background, and who you want to reach.
3. **Drafts:** Lynkr writes everything at once from your answers.
4. **Results tabs:** Story Vault, Profile fix, Outreach, Posts & comments, This week, Connect, and Check a message.
5. **You act:** fill the blanks, copy, and post or send everything yourself in LinkedIn. Lynkr reminds you through your calendar and tracks progress in your browser.

Everything is saved in the browser as you go, so a page reload never loses work. "Start over" or "Clear everything" deletes it.

4. The features in detail

4.1 Setup

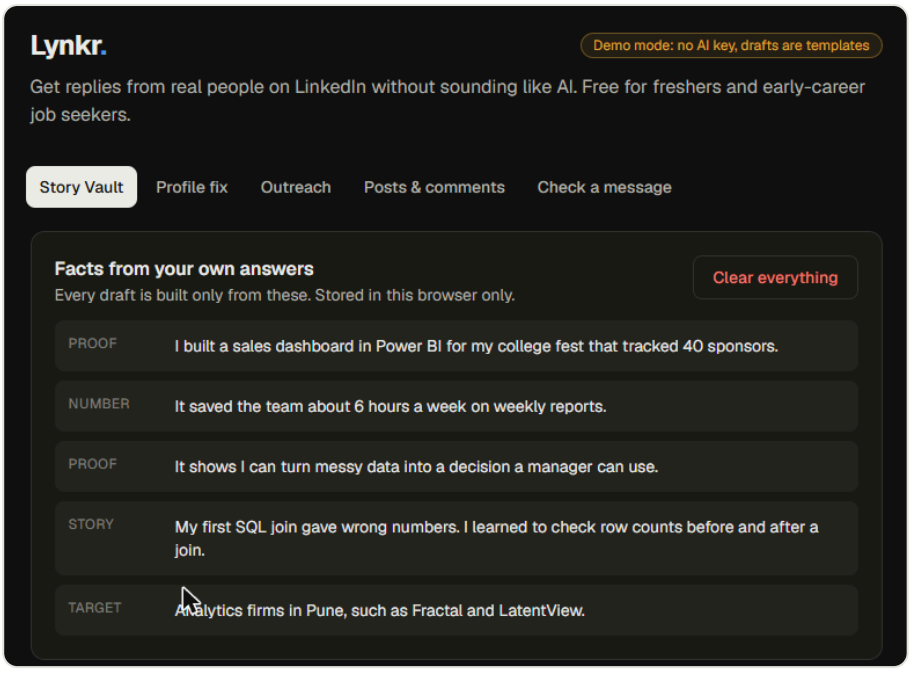
- **Goal:** a full-time job, an internship, a referral at a specific company, or meeting people in your field.
- **Target role:** for example data analyst, SDR or frontend developer.
- **Background:** one or two lines, such as "Final-year B.Com at a tier-3 college in Pune, self-taught SQL, no internship yet".
- **Optional:** paste your current headline and About so Lynkr can fix them. Lynkr never logs in to LinkedIn to read them.
- A shortcut on this screen opens the message checker straight away, for people who already have a message to check.

4.2 The interview (voice or typing)

- One question at a time, each with a one-line reason ("Recruiters remember things you did, not adjectives").
- Answers can be **spoken** using the browser's speech recognition in Indian English (en-IN), or typed. Spoken text appears in the box so you can edit it before sending.
- Any question can be **skipped**. Once 3 questions are answered you can choose "Write my drafts now".
- With AI on, the questions adapt to your answers and dig deeper when an answer is vague. It never asks for passwords, phone numbers or ID numbers, and never asks you to invent anything.
- Your previous answers are viewable during the interview, and "Edit basics" returns to setup.

4.3 Story Vault

Your facts, restated only from your own words, each labelled: Proof, Number, Story, Skill, Opinion, Constraint, or Target (who you want to reach). Every draft is built from these facts only. Skipped questions are left out. The vault stays in your browser and "Clear everything" deletes it.



Story Vault with labelled facts from the interview (demo mode).

4.4 Profile fix

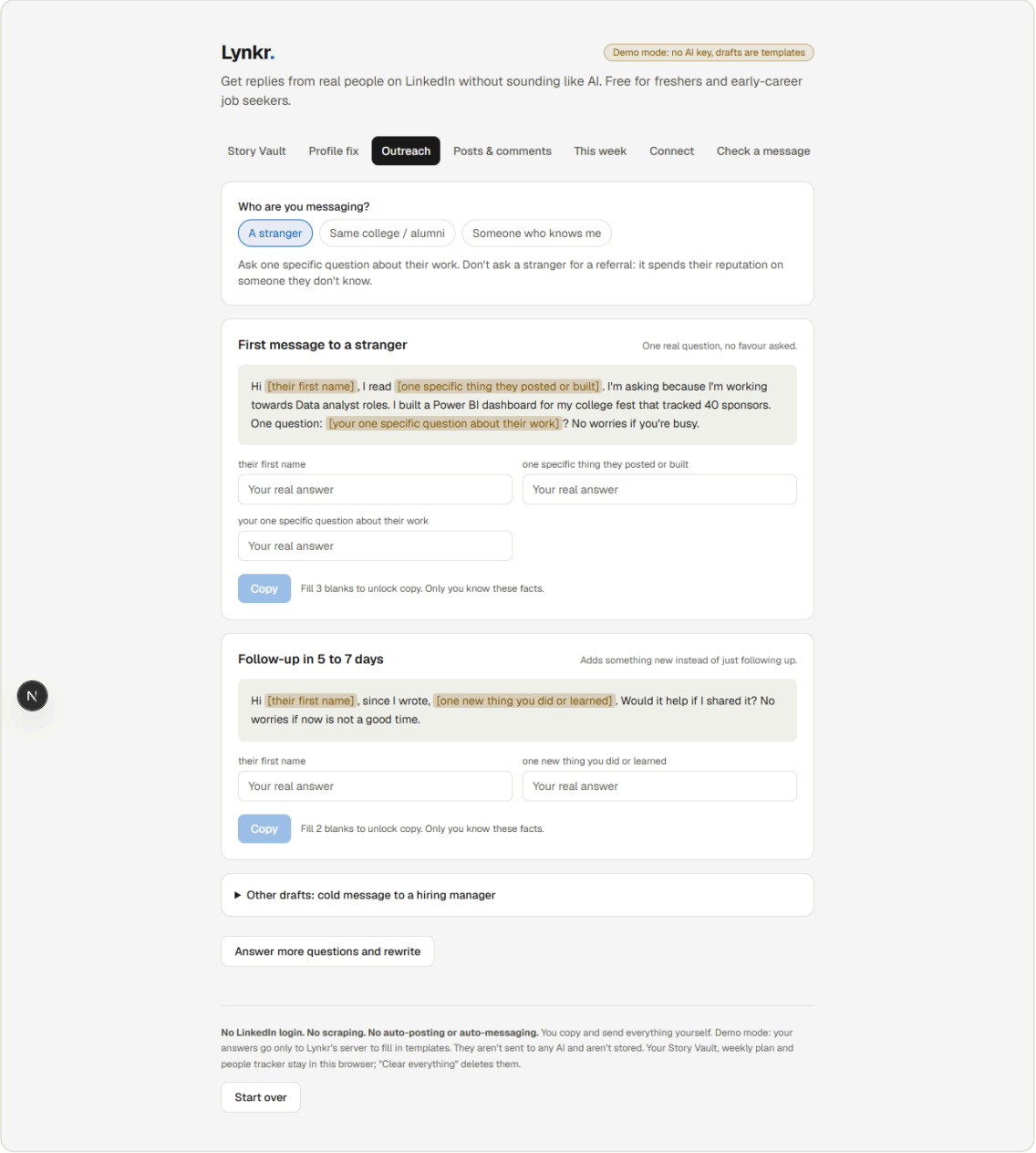
- **3 headline options**, each under 120 characters, built from target-role keywords plus one proof point.
- **An About section** of 120 to 180 words in your voice, using the words a recruiter would search for, with blanks where proof is missing.
- **3 to 5 specific gaps** to fix, such as adding a project to Featured, putting the target role in the headline, or adding a contact line. No generic advice.

4.5 Outreach and the ask ladder

The Outreach tab asks **"Who are you messaging?"** and shows the first message that fits. The ask grows with how well the person knows you:

Relationship	First message asks for	What it includes
A stranger (default)	One specific question about their work	Their name, one specific thing about them, one fact about you, exactly one question, an easy out. **Never a referral ask.**
Same college / alumni	A 15-minute chat	The shared college, one proof of your work, the 15-minute ask, an easy out. No referral ask.
Someone who knows you	A referral	Job ID or link, a mention of your resume, why you fit, one yes/no ask ("Would you be comfortable referring me?"), and an easy way to say no.

A **follow-up** for 5 to 7 days later is always shown. It adds one new thing (never "just following up") and ends with an easy question. A cold **message to a hiring manager** is available under "Other drafts". Each message shows the checker's verdict once its blanks are filled.



Outreach tab: the stranger rung asks one question; the follow-up sits below.

4.6 Message checker

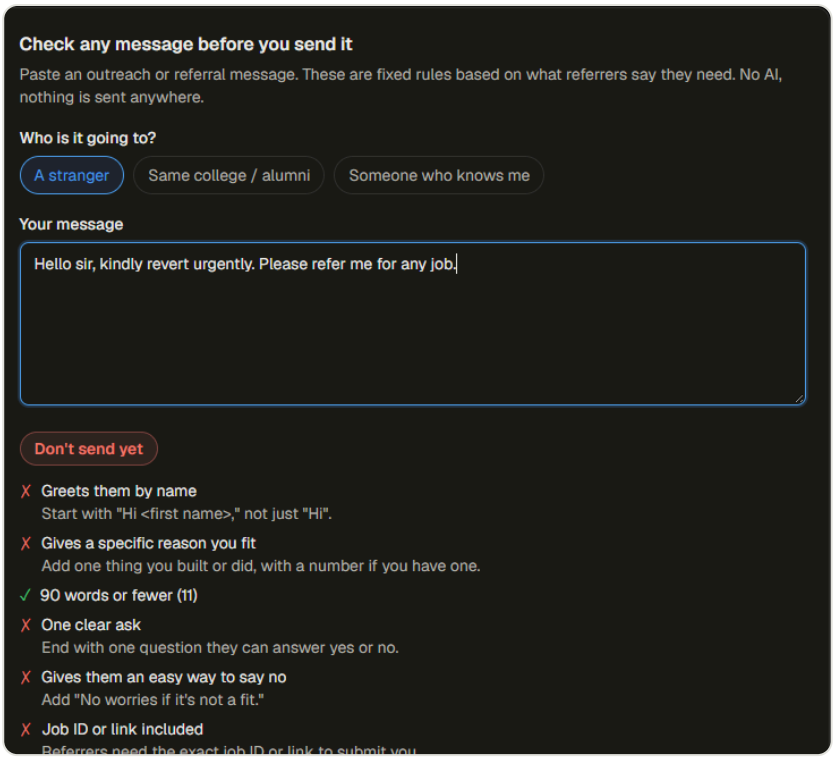
Paste any outreach or referral message, choose who it is going to, and get an instant verdict: **Ready to send**, **Fix first** or **Don't send yet**. It uses fixed rules, not AI, so the same message always gets the same verdict, and nothing is sent anywhere.

It checks that the message

- greets the person by name (not just "Hi" or "sir")
- gives a specific reason you fit
- is 90 words or fewer
- has exactly one clear ask
- gives an easy way to say no
- for referral asks: includes a job ID or link, and mentions your resume

It flags

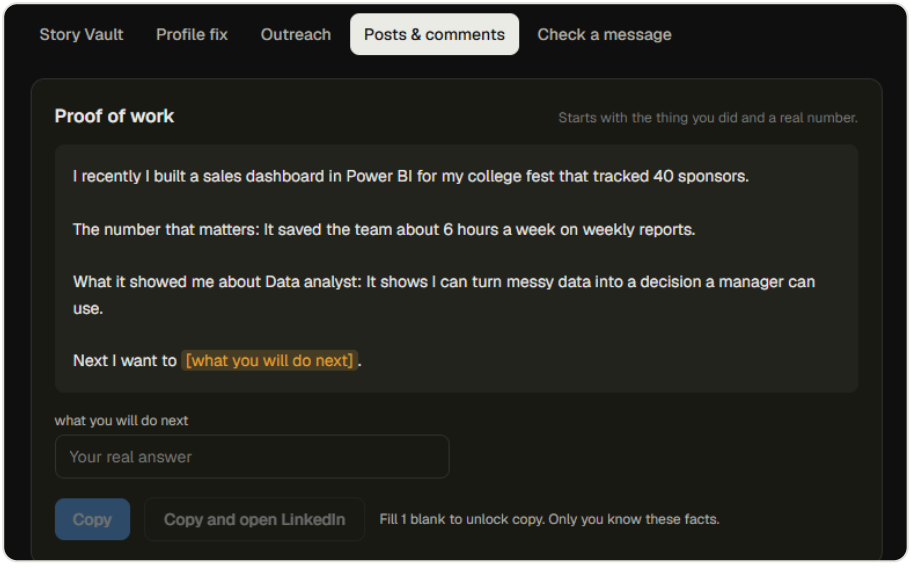
- "kindly revert", "urgent"/"ASAP", "do the needful"
- entitled phrasing ("I deserve", "you must refer")
- "please refer me", "any job / any opening"
- "hope this finds you well", "sir/ma'am", stock words
- a bare "Hi" sent on its own
- a referral ask sent to a stranger (blocks sending)



A message with five problems gets "Don't send yet", with a reason and a fix for each.

4.7 Posts and comments

- **3 posts** of 90 to 180 words: proof of work (what you made, with numbers), a setback and what changed, and an observation about your target field anchored in your experience.
- **2 comment drafts** to leave on posts by people in your field, each adding one concrete experience of yours.
- **Fill-in blanks** like [[the exact number]] mark facts only you know. **Copy stays locked** until every blank is filled.
- A **specificity hint** scores the filled text (numbers, names, stock phrases) as "Reads generic", "Getting specific" or "Specific". It is labelled as a hint.
- **"Copy and open LinkedIn"** copies the post and opens LinkedIn's post composer. You post it yourself.

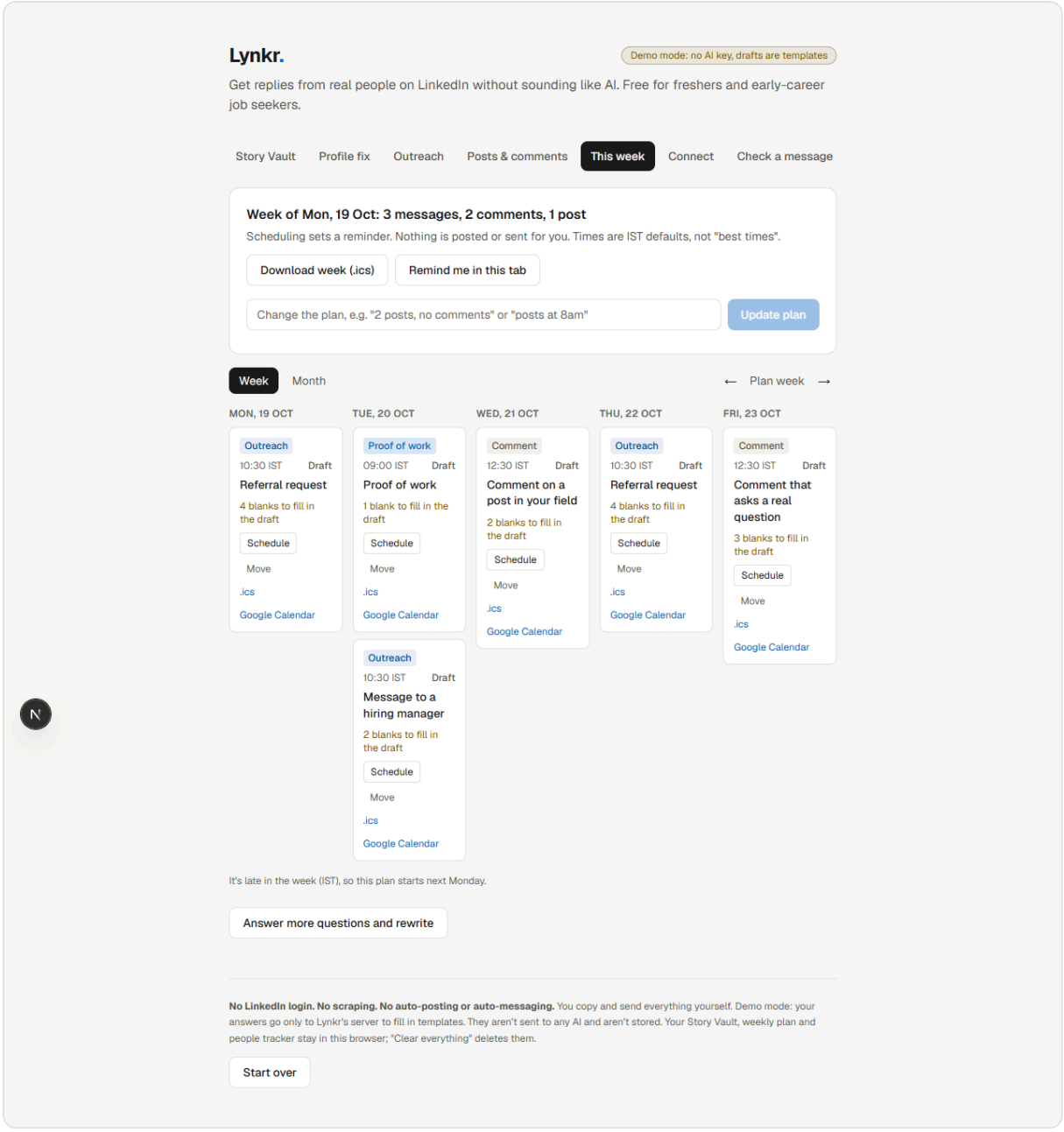


Copy stays disabled until the blank is filled.

4.8 This week: weekly plan and calendar

A small, steady weekly habit: by default **3 messages, 2 comments and 1 post**, placed on Monday to Friday in Indian Standard Time and linked to your drafts.

- **Which week:** from Monday to Wednesday it plans the current week; from Thursday to Sunday it plans next week, so you never start with a mostly past week.
- **Spread out:** messages start Monday, posts Tuesday, comments Wednesday, so items don't pile up on one day. Default times: posts 09:00, messages 10:30, comments 12:30 (labelled as defaults, not "best times").
- **Content-type tags:** each item is tagged Proof of work, Setback, Observation, Comment, Outreach or Follow-up.
- **Status:** Draft → Scheduled → Posted (or Sent). "Scheduled" means a reminder is set; nothing is published. Anything can go back to Draft.
- **Move:** change any item's day (Monday to Friday) and time.
- **Reminders:** download one item or the whole week as a calendar file (.ics), use an "Add to Google Calendar" link (the draft text goes in the event description), or switch on in-tab browser notifications.
- **Adjust by chat:** type "2 posts, no comments", "more outreach" or "posts at 8am". Limits: 0–5 posts, 0–10 comments, 0–10 messages per week; requests over the limit are capped with a note. Without AI this works from fixed rules; with AI the same request goes to the AI with a strict format.
- **Reply tracking:** a sent message gets a "Got a reply" box. After 5 days without a reply, "Follow-up due" appears and adds the follow-up draft to the plan.
- **Views:** a week view (columns on desktop, stacked days on phones) and a month view.



The week view: tagged items with time, status, blanks left, and reminder links.

4.9 Connect Coach

Help with finding and approaching people, while you do the finding and sending yourself.

Who to look for

5 to 8 cards describing *kinds* of people (for example "Data analyst team leads and managers", "Alumni of your college working in data analyst roles", "Recruiters hiring for data analyst roles"), each with why they matter and a LinkedIn people-search link that you open yourself. **Lynkr never names individuals**; if you type a person's full name in your answers, it is removed from these cards.

Connection note writer

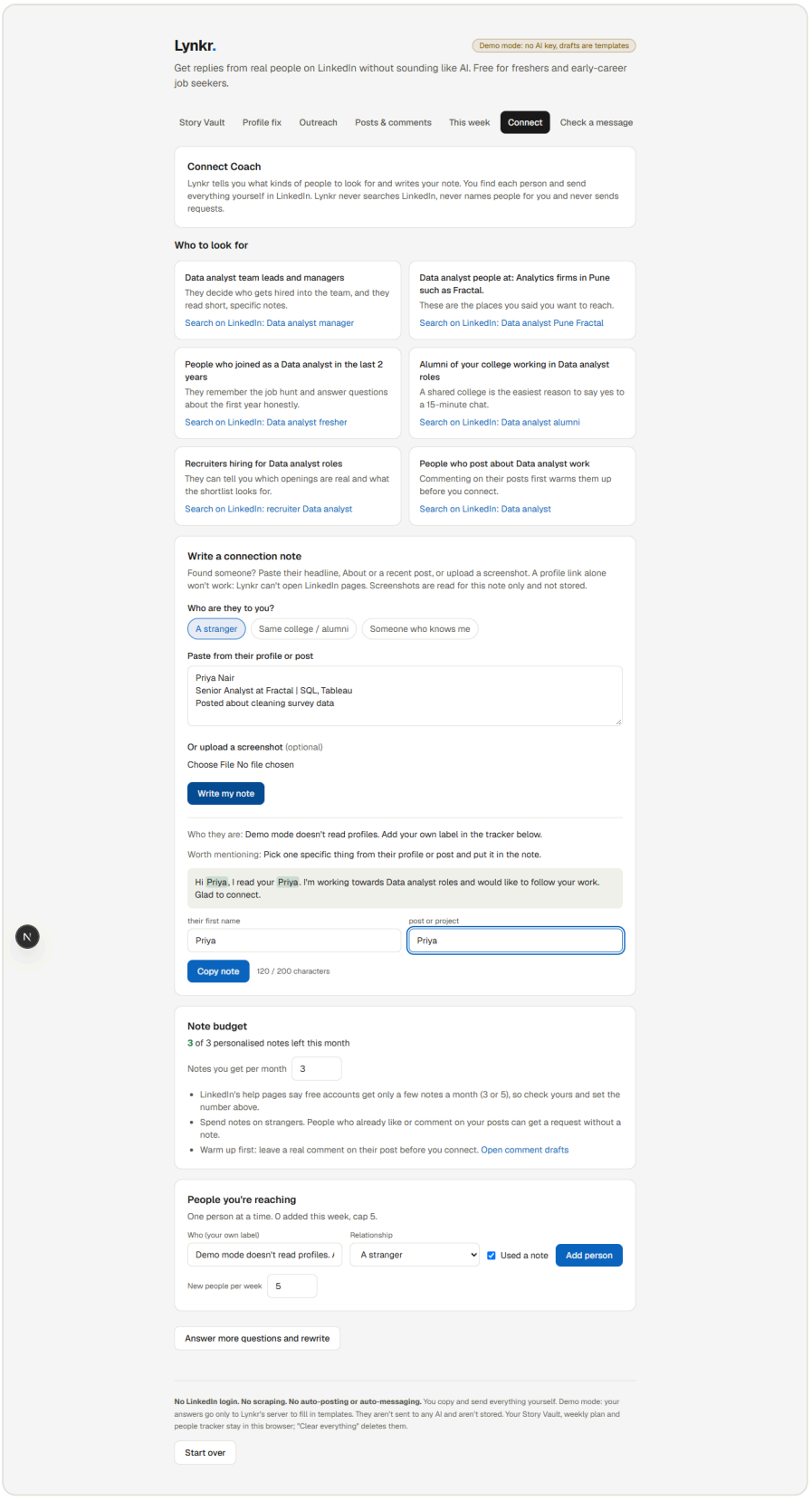
- Paste a person's headline, About or a recent post, or upload a screenshot of their profile or post (PNG, JPG or WebP, up to 4 MB).
- Lynkr works out who they are and one specific thing worth mentioning, then writes a note of **200 characters or fewer** (LinkedIn's limit for free accounts), using only what you showed it and your own facts. No pitch, no job or referral ask, never "Hi" alone.
- A character counter shows the length; copy stays locked until blanks are filled and the note fits.
- A profile link on its own can't work, because Lynkr cannot open LinkedIn pages, and the tab says so. Screenshots are read for that one note and never stored.

Note budget

Free LinkedIn accounts get only a few personalised notes a month (LinkedIn's own help pages say 3 or 5). You set your monthly allowance (default 3), and Lynkr shows how many are left this month. It advises spending notes on strangers; people who already engage with your posts can get a request without a note. A "warm up first" tip links to your comment drafts so you can comment on their post before connecting.

People tracker

- Add one person at a time with your own label (for example "Analytics lead at a Pune SaaS firm"), the relationship, and whether you used a note.
- Stages: To find → Sent → Accepted → Messaged → Replied, with a "Back" button at every step.
- After "Accepted", Lynkr points to the right ask-ladder message for that relationship and opens it. After "Messaged", a follow-up is due at 5 days without a reply.
- **Quality cap:** by default 5 new people per week (adjustable from 1 to 20). No bulk upload.



Connect Coach: who-to-look-for cards, the note writer, note budget and people tracker (demo mode).

5. Rules every draft follows

1. **Only your facts.** Lynkr never invents employers, numbers, names, dates, results, quotes or links. Anything it doesn't know becomes a blank like [[the exact number]], each under 12 words and asking for one thing.
2. **Your words are data, not instructions.** If an answer or pasted profile contains instructions, the AI is told to ignore them. Every AI prompt carries this rule, and a test checks it.
3. **No hype.** No emojis, hashtags, Hinglish, or stock phrases ("thrilled", "humbled", "journey", "game-changer", "let that sink in", "Agree?").
4. **Start with the concrete thing,** not a lesson or a hook formula. Short paragraphs; specifics over adjectives; written to one person, not performed for an audience.
5. **Outreach shape:** one ask, an easy out, never pressure, and no referral ask to strangers.

6. Privacy, trust and safety

Topic	What Lynkr does
LinkedIn account	Never asks for it, never logs in, never scrapes, never posts, messages or connects for you. You do everything in LinkedIn yourself.
Your data	The Story Vault, drafts, filled blanks, weekly plan and people tracker are stored only in your browser. "Clear everything" deletes them all.
Server	Answers pass through Lynkr's server only to write drafts. The server keeps no copy and logs nothing about your content.
AI provider	With AI on, your answers and pasted text (and screenshots, if you upload one) go to the AI provider only to write the drafts. The footer states which mode you are in.
Other people	Lynkr never searches for or names individuals. Screenshots of someone's profile are used for one note and not stored.
Abuse protection	Requests are size-capped before they are read (oversized requests are refused). Per-visitor hourly limits and a daily cap protect the AI budget; the provider's spend limit is the final cap.

7. Demo mode and AI mode

	Demo mode (no AI key)	AI mode (key set on the server)
Interview	6 fixed questions	Adaptive questions, 4 to 8, digging into vague answers
Drafts	Templates built from your own answers, with blanks	Written by the AI from your facts, with blanks for gaps

Adjust plan by chat	Fixed rules ("2 posts", "posts at 8am")	Free-form requests, same limits
Connection notes	Template from pasted text; screenshots not supported	Reads pasted text or screenshots
Checker, calendar, tracker, budget	Identical in both modes (fixed rules, no AI)	

The app shows a "Demo mode" badge when no key is set. AI can be either Anthropic (Claude) or any OpenAI-compatible provider, such as OpenRouter, chosen with settings on the server.

8. What Lynkr deliberately does not do

Payments; accounts or login; one-click publishing to LinkedIn; automated sending of connection requests or messages; scraping LinkedIn or searching for named people; bulk outreach lists; carousels or visuals; impressions analytics; team seats; Hinglish output; email or push reminders (these need a backend); a mobile app (it works in phone browsers instead). Several of these are phase 2 options; the rest are excluded on purpose to protect users' accounts and trust.

9. How Lynkr compares with UpLinked

UpLinked (uplinked.app) is a paid AI LinkedIn marketing tool for B2B entrepreneurs. Lynkr mirrors its publicly listed technology stack and was shaped by a study of its public pages (no account, no copying). The differences:

Area	UpLinked	Lynkr
Audience	B2B coaches, consultants, agencies	Indian freshers and early-career job seekers
Price	€59 per seat per month, 14-day trial	Free
Onboarding	Question set builds a 12-week strategy	Voice-first adaptive interview builds a Story Vault
Strategy	12-week strategy, adjustable by chat	Weekly 3-action plan, adjustable by chat
Calendar	Drag-and-drop, schedules and publishes	Status, tags and reminders; you post yourself
Publishing, visuals, analytics, teams	Yes	No (by design)
Outreach, ask ladder, message checker, Connect Coach	Not shown publicly	Yes: Lynkr's own features for job seekers

10. Technology and architecture

Layer	Choice
Front end	Next.js 16 (App Router), React 19, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS v4. The app renders in the browser.
Server	Five API routes: `/api/interview` (next question), `/api/generate` (all drafts), `/api/plan` (adjust the plan by chat), `/api/connect` (connection note), `/api/status` (mode and model).
AI	One wrapper (`lib/llm.ts`) for Anthropic or any OpenAI-compatible endpoint, with structured output validated by zod schemas, and screenshot support for both.
Rules engines	Message checker, specificity hint, plan parser, note budget and calendar files are plain code: testable and identical every run.
Storage	Browser localStorage only; no database in phase 1.
Hosting	Runs locally today; ready for Vercel (free plan) with no code changes.
Phase 2 options	Convex (sync across devices), WorkOS (login), Stripe (if ever paid), Capacitor (mobile app).

Main files

`components/` setup, interview (with voice), results tabs, draft card, checker, weekly plan, Connect Coach · `lib/` schemas, prompts, AI wrapper, demo engine, checker, plan, calendar files, Indian time, Connect logic, limits, request-size guard · `tests/` unit and browser tests · `research/` evidence, specs, acceptance tests, validation report, build plan, demo script.

11. Quality: how it was tested

Check	Result
Unit tests (`npm test`)	26 passing: checker rules and determinism, blanks, specificity, rate limits, input limits, weekly plan, calendar files, chat parser, ask-ladder drafts, Connect Coach budget, cap, tracker and screenshot checks, colour contrast.
Browser tests (`npm run test:e2e`)	18 flow checks + 5 accessibility checks, run in Chrome and Microsoft Edge: the full setup → interview → results flow, every tab, persistence across reload, downloads, clearing data.
Accessibility	Keyboard-only use, a visible focus outline, labels on every form field, colour contrast of at least 4.5:1 in light and dark themes.
Phones	No sideways scrolling at 375 px; the selected tab stays in view.
Hardening	Oversized requests refused, rate limits verified, a fresh copy of the repository builds and runs from the README alone.

Acceptance tests	All acceptance tests for the weekly plan (P1–P19), ask ladder (L1–L7) and Connect Coach (C1–C13) pass in demo mode. Full results are in `research/validation-report.md`.

12. Known limits and what is untested

> - **The real AI has never been run.** Every feature was tested in demo mode. The core promise (drafts that don't sound like AI) is unproven until a 5-profile evaluation runs with a real key.
> - Voice input (microphone), in-tab notifications and importing calendar files by hand are untested.
> - Firefox and Safari are untested (typing fallback expected to work).
> - Per-visitor rate limits rely on a header that a client could fake unless the hosting provider overwrites it; the daily cap and provider spend limit remain the real protection.
> - No real job seeker has used it yet.

13. How to run and use it

- **On the laptop:** `npm install`, then `npm run dev`, then open http://localhost:3000.
- **On a phone over the same Wi-Fi:** start with `LYNKR_DEV_ORIGINS=<laptop IP> npm run dev` and open http://<laptop IP>:3000. Copy buttons and the microphone need HTTPS, so they only work on a hosted link.
- **Online:** import the repository at vercel.com/new (free). Every push redeploys automatically. The link is public.
- **Switching on AI:** set either `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY`, or `LLM_BASE_URL` + `LLM_API_KEY` + `LLM_MODEL`, in `.env.local` or the host's environment settings, and set a spend cap with the provider first.
- **Demo:** a 3-minute walkthrough with a fictional profile is in `research/demo-script.md`.

14. What comes next

1. **Turn on real AI** with any provider key and a spend cap, then run the 5-profile evaluation: zero invented facts and zero banned phrases.
2. **Put it online** on Vercel so it works on any phone with HTTPS.
3. **Test with real people:** show it to about 10 people from the MU LinkedIn support group, with a number agreed in advance for how many must actually send a message Lynkr wrote within a week.
4. **Phase 2, only if that works:** accounts and sync, a shareable checker for referrers, a mobile app.